

Q. How do you see the smart lighting market?

A. Smart lighting is, undoubtedly, the way of the future. Till a while back, it was only limited to commercial buildings and grand apartments. However, the concept is now transforming immensely as the idea of smart lighting and home automation is finding a place in the lives of many middle-class and upper middle-class families. With smart lighting becoming affordable and easily accessible, the demand for the same is rising at a fast pace.

With an upsurge in smartphone and tablet usage, smart technologies are becoming more affordable and prevalent. Additionally, the government's Smart Cities Mission initiative on building smart cities—the core of which is formed by the Internet of Things—has provided a boost to the establishment of smart lighting.

A Global Market Insights report forecasts the smart lighting market size to reach US\$ 8.5 billion by 2023, growing annually at over 22 per cent from 2016 to 2023. Rapidly growing energy conservation demand along with rising need of maintaining an intelligent lighting ecosystem is anticipated to drive the industry over the forecast period.

Q. What are the ongoing trends in wireless lighting?

A. As per the growing demands in the wireless lighting industry, there are numerous trends and new technologies participating to create an environment for end users.

For example, keypads will go wireless, ensuring failure-proof communication between the controller and switching/dimming modules. Now people can add additional control points at their home anywhere, anytime even after moving-in. Your keypad can be installed onto any surface, including glass or furniture surface.

You can also use smart devices



Ripu Daman Sharma, country sales manager, Lutron Electronics

like iPad, iPhone or Android devices to control your lighting, shades and HVAC. Last but not the least, you can even control your home or office environment by using voice command via Alex, Google Home or Siri.

Daylight sensors and occupancy sensors will go wireless. Wireless sensors will save a lot of installation time and cost. It's also much easier to identify the best location of the sensors without the inconvenience of an attaching cable. It's also more flexible to accommodate future change in the layout of any space.

Q. What are the benefits of wireless lighting control?

A. A room's lighting is the first and foremost thing that gets noticed by anyone. Too much lighting can be uncomfortable, while insufficient lighting can strain one's eyes. Lighting control systems are designed to provide the right amount of light where and when it is needed.

Lighting control solutions have been proven to significantly reduce lighting energy consumption, complement design and enhance the usability. Usually, many people are hesitant to install these solutions due to high cost involved, complexity and applicability. However, new wireless technologies are eliminating these concerns, while expanding the lighting control capabilities.

Ease of use and flexibility, scal-

ability and non-destructive installation are key benefits of wireless lighting control.

You don't have to worry about unwanted electrical charges due to unintentionally leaving the lights on. An easy access from mobile phone or tablet means you can control lights no matter where you are.

Once a wireless network is established, that network can be used to cover an ever-expanding area at a low additional cost. Additional sensors, switches and lights require minimal labour and disruption, and utilise the same wireless control system without the need to add a new control infrastructure.

Wireless systems are more beneficial as people do not have to make drastic changes to their walls, reducing costs incurred in re-doing the walls.

Q. What role does control play in wireless lighting?

A. Home control provides you the ability to adjust the amount of daylight and electric light, temperature, and power used by appliances in a room or throughout your home. It helps to save energy and lessen the impact on environment, add convenience to your daily life, create just the right mood or ambience for any activity, and add cutting-edge technology to your home.

Q. What lies at the heart of wireless lighting?

A. Wireless lighting utilises the intelligence of software technology and sensors to make people's lives simpler and convenient. It is designed for energy efficiency. The technology allows LEDs to sense where the light is needed and accordingly set different colours and intensity of light. Simply put, smart or wireless lighting, is associated with a system that provides centralised lighting control. **EFY**

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